

Backstory

Reincarnation of a deity

How did it feel when I first came into being? It felt scary. Waking up all alone with no memories. Some think that gods are born. In a sense they are, I suppose. The toddler stage is spent as an incorporeal being, merely a spirit floating about. You don't coalesce into conciseness until much later. By that point, you are more of an adolescent than a child.

I recall opening up my eyes staring up at the sky. It was a cloudy day. The snow faintly falling around the pure white landscape. A howling wind marked my entrance into this world. Perhaps the greater deities get a resounding boom—I recall chuckling to myself at the thought.

Why was I brought into this world? Who believed in me enough to bring me into being? They say we start as mere ideas. With enough belief, we grow into spirits able to wander around the ethereal plane. To become corporeal requires at least one person's wish. A wish for what though?

I remember nothing of my previous incarnation. I only have a vague feeling that they existing long, long ago. It appears in the modern day that most of the gods have retreated from this plane in fear. Perhaps my believers felt I could save them?

What am I? I am the manifestation of gentle snow. I am that which graces the limbs of empty trees. The first dusting of winter. A fresh powder lightly falling from the sky. There is a reserved power there, for a gentle snow fall can quickly turn into a fierce squall. But that feels like a far cry from the power needed to save someone.

I awoke in a clearing within a taiga. Fitting, given my spirit. The tall pine trees sought to touch the clouds. Be it to escape winters chill and feel the sun sitting above, or merely seeking to grab the first flakes of snow, I cannot say. I like to believe it's the latter. They felt welcoming at least. Homey, in a way.

The sparse wildlife welcomed my arrival. Hunters and prey alike sat arrayed around the clearing. From rabbits to elk to wolves to bears to crows. A frozen pond and large rock shrouded in a white moss were the only other features. We sat there for a time, admiring one another, before they began to disperse.

My reflection surprised me. A small framed, pale elven girl with flowing white hair was no shock, but those stark, glaring pale blue eyes felt so icy cold compared to the soft features of my face. What must the person who brought me into being have thought of me if they imagined me so.

Before long I became hungry. Strange, feeling hunger for the first time. The taste of castle berries was another shock. But no greater shock was seeing civilization for the first time—or rather, the remnants. I found myself staring down at a burning city from the mountain range I had crossed to arrive here. The Spine of Halgoth, as I later heard it referred to as.

It was in Idris that I learned why the gods had fled. Mors Altum. Why anyone believed I could provide sanctuary from that, I have no idea. Perhaps one day I will find the one who wished for me and ask.

Character Development

Backstory questions

Q: How does she feel about being born?

A: She is overall happy she has been born. It means someone believes in her. But she's more curious than anything. Why would someone wish for her to be born? What could she possibly do to influence their life?

Q: What did she do after she was born?

A: Wandered around Yidris briefly. She found herself in the Findal Dynasty after crossing the Ivory Berg. After getting her bearings she traveled to Yorin as a refugee.

Q: What are her goals?

A: To find who wished for her birth. To survive. Selfishly, she wants a shrine built to honor her. She prefers an Eastern style, so something with a Torii.

Q: What is her relation to Auril?

A: Auril is an evil fey deity who wishes to bring about an eternal winter. Celeste has no such aspirations. Being that Auril has always been a much stronger deity, she doesn't make it a habit to oppose her or even be noticed by her. But it's safe to assume Auril probably doesn't care for her. Ultimately they are not directly connected or related.

Q: How did she become an expert sorcerer?

A: Her magical power is innate to her being a minor deity. Being born only recently, she is incredibly weak compared to that of a mature deity.

Q: What did you do before the campaign begins?

A: Floated around the ethereal plane, mostly. After being born, wandered the Ivory Berg for some time. Likely months to years. Eventually she made it to Findal and discovered the reason for the gods' retreat. She laid low in the Findal Dynasty before moving onto Yorin. She blended in as a refugee, so she didn't have many problems traveling. Being that she is still so weak, she slides underneath the notice of any other deities.

Q: Why did you accept the job given by the merchant Gerard to escort him and his ship to Lyndon?

A: Money. It's impossible to do much on your own in this world without money.

Q: Thoughts on Whiskey's Whiskers?

A: Cute name. Lots of personality. Not super big into whiskey though.

Q: What are her thoughts on the All Mother?

A: She's a complete unknown. Finding out more about her and her following would be prudent, but otherwise would prefer to avoid her notice entirely.

Personality questions

Q: What is her favorite tea?

A: Green tea

Q: What is her favorite food?

A: Soufflé pancakes

Q: What is her favorite color?

A: White, obviously. If that “doesn’t count”, then blue.

Q: What does she like to wear?

A: Kimonos mostly, or some other robed garment. Yakuta when bedding down.

Q: What is her normal demeanor?

A: Mostly a blank unreadable expression. At a glance she may be described as cold, but it’s really just being reserved until her curiosity gets the better of her. She is very curious.

Q: What is a personality trait that isn’t obvious at a glance?

A: Exceptionally curious

Q: What is a personality trait that is obvious at a glance?

A: Confidence, intelligence

Q: Any personality quirks that others notice?

A: She gets really excited about mundane things like berries.

Q: Is she religious?

A: Given that she is a deity herself, yes.

Q: What does she look like?

A: She is a high elf with a pale complexion. On the shorter side, maybe a little taller than 5 feet but not by much. Compared to an average human, she appears to be in her early 20s. She has long white hair that she usually keeps down. Soft facial features other than her eyes which are a pale frost blue with an ice cold stare.

Q: What does she sound like?

A: Normal soft elf voice

Q: How does she view the world in plain terms?

A: People are net good for the world. The gods have their issues, case by case basis.

Q: Does she have any enemies?

A: Not yet

Q: Does she have any friends?

A: Not really. She’s met people along the way to Yorin, but she’s more or less kept to herself.

Q: How does she feel about animals?

A: They’re cute, especially the fluffy ones.

Character Planning

Name: Celeste

Class: Draconic Sorcerer

Race: High Elf -> Perception // Prestidigitation, Detect Magic, Misty Step

Sorcerer: Arcana, Persuasion

Background: Acolyte -> Insight, Religion

Feat: Elemental Adept (1), War Caster (4), Inspiring Leader (8), Metamagic Adept (12)

- Others: Skill Expert, Tough, Alert

Alternate Names: Evelyn, Valcyne, Lyra, Valindra, Ilythyrra, Yra, Deva, Eva, Meadow, Agatha, Aurora, Auriel, Lydia, Frost, Dawn, Moira (Vale), Rue, Grove, Snow, Azalea, Willow, Rowan, Celeste